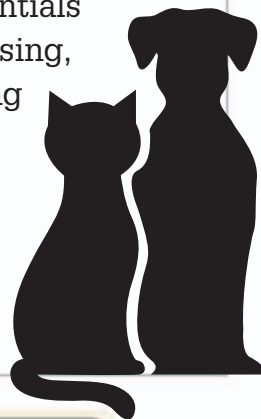




ANIMAL CARE WORKER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Animal care workers provide the essentials of life—from food and water to exercising, cleaning, grooming, and administering medical care—to ensure that pets or domesticated animals are healthy. They work in a range of places, such as kennels, stables, pet stores, rescue centers, and animal hospitals.



SALARY

Animal care worker ★★★★★
Animal care manager ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Job tasks can vary greatly from one position to another • Public interest in treatment of domestic and captive animals has tightened standards

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS • Animal welfare • English • Chemistry • Mathematics • Biology • Physical education



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Formal qualifications are not always required; some vocational training in animal care is desirable.



LIFESTYLE Since animal care is an all-day job, working hours often involve shifts over evenings, weekends, or public holidays.



LOCATION The work is often outdoors, and may involve a range of domesticated or wild animals. Travel is often required, either to move animals or visit sites.



THE REALITIES Salaries are modest and the work often physically exhausting. Some situations can be emotionally upsetting.

RELATED CAREERS

► **ZOOKEEPER** *see pp. 164–165*

► **ANIMAL TECHNICIAN** Cares for laboratory animals used for research in the medical, veterinary, and dental industries. Animal technologists are responsible for the welfare of the animals, and may also administer medication and monitor the animals during testing.

► **VETERINARY TECHNICIAN** Assists vets in taking care of sick, injured, or hospitalized animals. Veterinary nurses may take X-rays, prepare animals for surgery, administer drugs and treatments, and also keep records. A degree in veterinary nursing is usually needed, but it may be possible to qualify through vocational study and experience.



In the United States, animal care is expected to grow 15 percent between 2012 and 2022.